

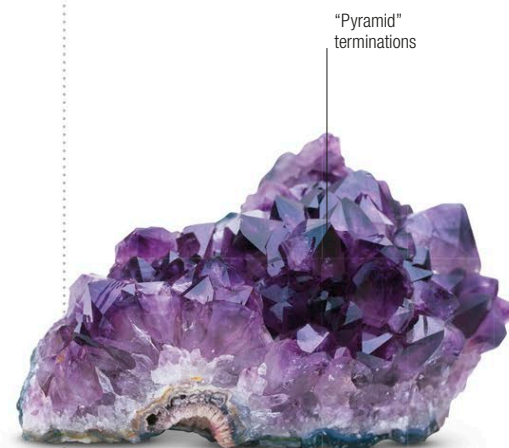
Rough



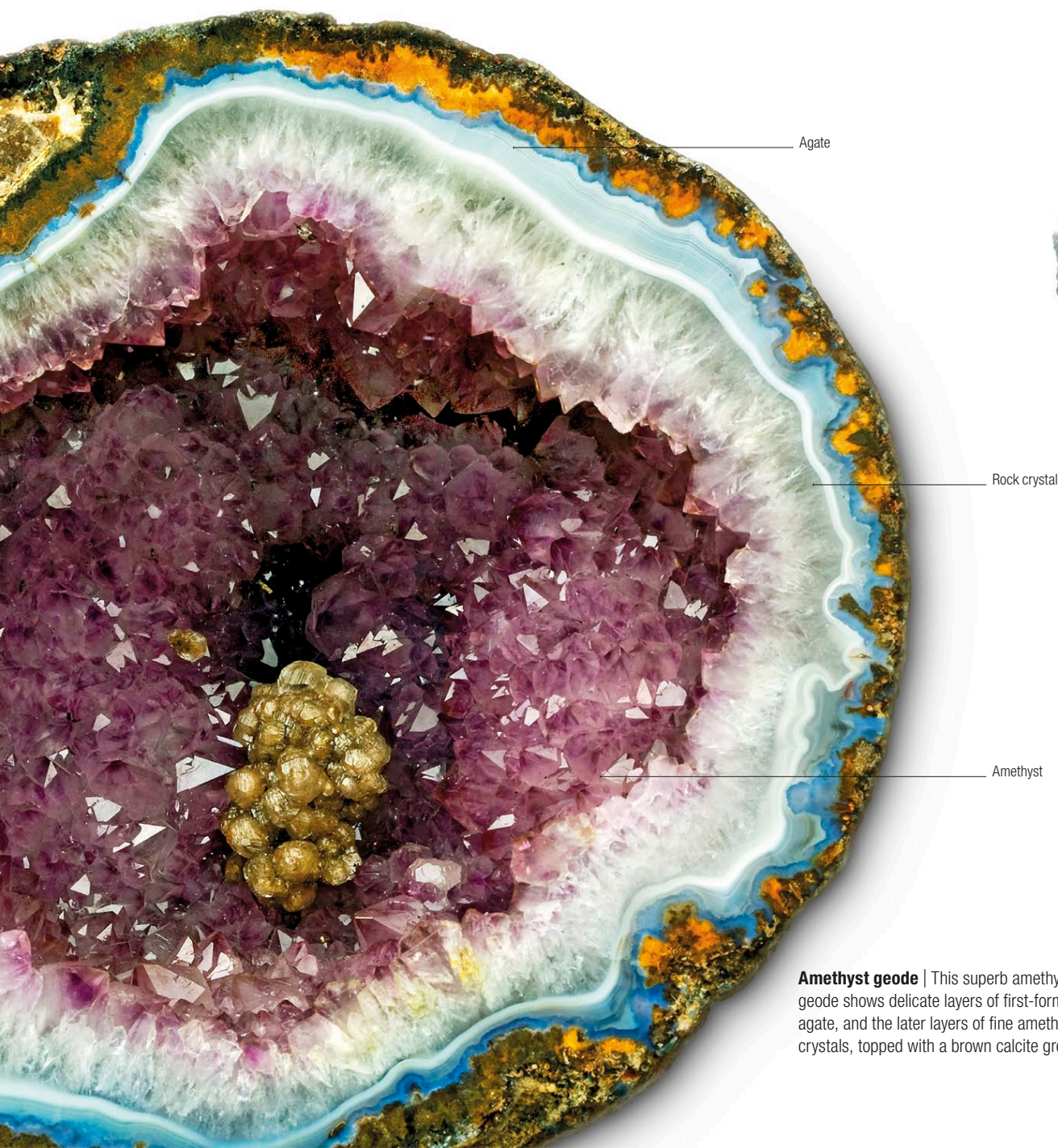
Rock crystal on agate | This cross-sectional mineral slice reveals quartz in two different forms – as a base layer of cryptocrystalline agate, and the upper layer of rock crystal upon which the former rests.



Agate geode | This geode – a mineral infilling an air bubble left in flowing lava after cooling – was first lined with agate, then later overgrown by tiny quartz crystals.



Amethyst crystals | These crystals show pyramid-shaped terminations. They are a section of a massive, amethyst-lined geode, some of which can be several feet across.

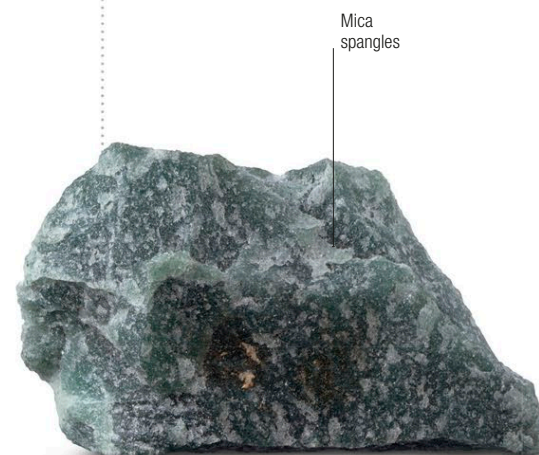


Agate

Rock crystal

Amethyst

Amethyst geode | This superb amethyst geode shows delicate layers of first-formed agate, and the later layers of fine amethyst crystals, topped with a brown calcite group.



Mica spangles

Aventurine rough | Dotted with tiny scales of mica or hematite, the quartz variety crystalline aventurine comes in various colours, and is popular for cabochons or tumbled stones.



Double-terminated quartz

Smoky quartz | This beautifully crystallized, double-terminated smoky quartz rests in a groundmass of milky quartz. Black quartz is sometimes known as morion.